

## Just Bring It On

In addition to VCDs, DVDs and MP3 CDs, the Mitashi DIVX-555 multimedia player can play MPEG4, JPEG, HDCD, and many other media formats. A two-channel audio and composite video cable to connect to a TV is also provided. Some more supported features are wide-screen TV support, an S-Video as well as Composite-out, a D-Sub connector to connect to a PC monitor, SP-DIF coaxial and optical output, Dolby Digital 5.1, Pro Logic II and DTS, to name a few.

We put it to test by playing DivX-encoded movies on it, and it performed without any glitches. When a non-standard compliant media is inserted in the player, an easy, Explorer-like interface pops up so you can navigate the folders on the media.

We then went one step further and tried to play a movie encoded with the newer and now very popular XVID (also an implementation of MPEG4) video compression and with Dolby 5.1 sound. We were pleasantly surprised to see that it not only played the movie flawlessly, it also correctly detected and played the Dolby 5.1 sound format.

We then popped in the February 2005 *Digit* DVD, which had lots of wallpapers, to see if we could view them. We found that we could view all the images—even as a slide show. Previews were available in the Explorer view. VCDs

and DVDs, as expected, had no problem playing. The image quality in all these tests was crisp, and the colours vibrant. Sound reproduction, both in 2-speaker and 5.1-speaker modes, was also very good.

One thing to note is that the DivX-555 has a 3D sound processor that can recreate



sounds according to seven different preset environments, and this feature actually worked.

Overall, this is a great player. Add a 29-inch TV and a 5.1-speaker set, and what you have is a full-fledged home theatre.

Company **Mitashi Edutainment Pvt Ltd**  
Price **Rs 4,990**  
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Rating 

## Benq FP231W

### A Lovely Spread

This 23-inch LCD from Benq overwhelms you with its size, and is a pleasure to work with. It provides a range of connectivity options, including DVI-D, S-Video, Composite, and D-sub—which means that other than your PC, you can connect it to your DVD player, camcorder, game box and so on.

The OSD menu is very easy to use, but the buttons are on the left face of the panel, making it difficult to access. This model also has a picture-in-picture feature. It offers a cool 155-degree viewing angle in the Movie mode and 165 degrees in the Text mode, making it a perfect choice for viewing with friends around.

When we tested this model for performance using DisplayMate, it returned impressive results in the 'Point Shape' and 'Visibility' tests, where reproduction of a fine dot, as well as text on a coloured background, was crisp. The 16 ms response time claim, however, was shattered in the Passmark Monitor test, where tearing was visible in a white block moving at 100 pixels per second.

Graphics and CAD/CAM professionals who need accurate colour reproduction and accurate geometry must check out this panel. It is also highly recommended for movie buffs who can afford it—it's a lovely 23-inch spread, apart from being an LCD!



Company **BenQ India Pvt Ltd.**  
Price **Rs 1,25,000**  
Phone **022-25705230**  
Web site **www.benq.com**

Rating 

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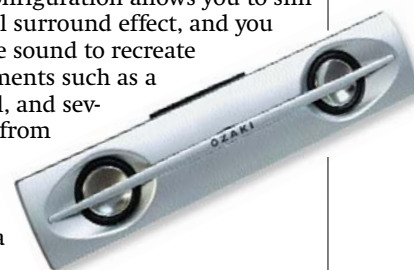
Please write to [products@thinkdigit.com](mailto:products@thinkdigit.com). The *Digit* Test Centre will be delighted to respond to your queries.

## Ozaki NB001

These two-channel speakers are specially designed for notebook users. Encased in a slim silver panel and weighing just 150 gm, the device can be clipped onto the top of a notebook, and it connects through the USB port. It draws power directly from the USB port, so there is no additional power adapter required. What's more, the bundled cable is detachable and retractable, reducing the tangle of wires you need to carry around.

The speaker configuration allows you to simulate a 5.1-channel surround effect, and you can also adjust the sound to recreate different environments such as a living room, a hall, and several others. Apart from the manual equaliser settings, you can also choose from a range of presets.

With 1W RMS output, the Ozaki NB001 speakers are not a match for the 5.1 speaker system you have at home, but are definitely better than most speakers integrated into notebooks today. The product is a worthy buy for executives who would, for example, like to enjoy their own music and movies in their hotel rooms while travelling.



Company **Rashi Peripherals**  
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Rating 

**1 Poor:** Has serious drawbacks and needs improvement before it can be used for its target application. **2 Mediocre:** Does not live up to expectations, needs improvement in many areas. **3 Average:** Reasonably competent but nothing spectacular about the product. **4 Good:** A good buy, better than most products in its category. **5 Excellent:** A brilliant combination of price, performance and features - far beyond expectations.